LEAVE POLICY

Purpose

The purpose of this Leave Policy is to establish clear and consistent rules for availing leave while ensuring compliance with applicable provisions of the **Maharashtra Shops and Establishments (Regulation of Employment and Conditions of Service) Act, 2017** and other applicable laws.

Weekly Offs

- Employees will be provided **two weekly offs per week on a rotational basis** as per the duty roster.
- Weekly offs may fall on any two days of the week and need not necessarily be Saturday and Sunday.
- Weekly offs are separate from the employee's leave entitlement, except where the Sandwich Leave provision under this policy applies.

Types of Leave

Employees may be eligible for the following types of leave, subject to applicable law and Company rules:

- **Casual Leave (CL)**
- **Sick/Medical Leave (SL)**
- **Privilege/Earned Leave (PL/EL)**
- **Maternity Leave**, as applicable under the Maternity Benefit Act, 1961
- **Leave Without Pay (LWP/Loss of Pay)**
- **Compensatory Off**, wherever applicable and approved by the Company

Casual Leave

- Casual Leave may be availed for personal or unforeseen requirements.
- Employees should apply for CL in advance wherever reasonably possible.
- In case of an emergency, the employee must inform the reporting manager/HR at the earliest possible time.
- CL shall be granted and accumulated in accordance with applicable law and the Company's approved leave structure.

Sick/Medical Leave

- Sick Leave may be availed when an employee is unwell or requires medical attention.
- The employee must inform the reporting manager/HR at the earliest possible time.
- The Company may request a medical certificate or supporting medical document where required, particularly for prolonged or repeated absence.
- Sick Leave entitlement shall be administered in accordance with applicable law and Company rules.

Privilege / Earned Leave

- Privilege/Earned Leave shall be credited and administered in accordance with applicable provisions of Maharashtra law.
- Leave entitlement shall be calculated based on the employee's eligibility and period of service.
- Employees should apply for planned PL/EL in advance and obtain approval before proceeding on leave.

- Carry-forward and encashment of PL/EL shall be governed by applicable law and Company rules.

Public Holidays

- Employees shall be entitled to holidays as declared by the Company in accordance with applicable Maharashtra law.
- Declared statutory/public holidays shall not ordinarily be deducted from the employee's leave balance.
- Where an employee is required to work on a declared holiday due to operational requirements, applicable compensatory holiday/payment provisions shall be followed as required by law.

Leave Application and Approval

- All planned leave must be applied through the prescribed HRMS/leave application process and approved by the reporting manager.
- Leave should be applied sufficiently in advance, except in cases of illness or emergency.
- Submission of a leave request does not automatically constitute approval.
- Employees must obtain approval before proceeding on planned leave.

Sandwich Leave

- The Sandwich Leave Rule may apply when an employee takes unapproved, unauthorized, or unplanned leave immediately before and after a weekly off or Company-declared holiday.
- The intervening weekly off(s) or holiday(s) may be counted as leave and deducted from the employee’s leave balance, subject to applicable law.
- **Approved leave with prior authorization shall not ordinarily attract the Sandwich Leave Rule.**

Unauthorized Absence

- Absence without prior approval or without informing the Company may be treated as unauthorized absence.
- Repeated or prolonged unauthorized absence may result in disciplinary action in accordance with Company policy and applicable law.
- Employees must maintain regular communication with their reporting manager/HR during any unforeseen absence.

Leave Without Pay

- Leave taken beyond the employee's available or approved leave entitlement may be treated as **Leave Without Pay (LWP)**, subject to management approval.
- Salary deduction for LWP shall be made in accordance with the Company's payroll rules and applicable law.

Leave During Notice Period

Employees serving their notice period must obtain prior approval for leave. Leave during the notice period may be regulated based on business requirements, applicable law, and the terms of the employee's employment agreement.

Leave During Probation

Employees on probation shall be eligible for leave in accordance with applicable law and the Company's leave policy. Leave taken during probation may be subject to prior approval and operational requirements.

Misuse of Leave

Providing false information, submitting fraudulent medical documents, or misrepresenting the reason for leave may result in disciplinary action.

Management Rights

The Company reserves the right to regulate the timing and approval of leave based on business and operational requirements, provided that such administration remains consistent with applicable labour laws and statutory entitlements.

Compliance

In case of any conflict between this policy and applicable statutory provisions, the applicable law shall prevail.